



GAGE Human Subjects



Respect, Minimal Harm, and Fairness

As researchers, the most important priority is to ensure the safety and security of the research participant; by minimizing any associated risks and loss of privacy.

There are three basic principles of ethical research that should guide all interactions with every study participant. Those three principles are:

- 1. Respect**
- 2. Minimal harm**
- 3. Fairness**

Human Subjects

Ethics and Rules of Conduct of Interviews: Showing Respect

- The data collector is the “ambassador” for the study.
- People (including the research participants and community members) will judge the study based on interactions with enumerators, supervisors and other researchers.

Respecting the Community

- Show good respect to the community by following their rules!
- If community members inquire about the enumerators, they should politely explain the project using the text in the information sheet or the consent forms.
- Don't make any promises or support or benefit, manage expectations.
- Try to participate in the social norms and customs – women should wear the appropriate clothing and cover hair where necessary. In home, may be invited to sit on the ground. Respect customs such as fasting, even if you do not follow them yourself at home. If you are Christian visiting a Muslim household, be respectful.
- Personal hygiene of enumerators is important

Approaching the Household

- Speak to elder if present. Then speak to the household head if present. Finally, speak to the wife of the head. This order may change, depending on the community and context. Ask your supervisor for guidance.
- Consent from household head or a parent (do not need both if they are not both there) or a caregiver if parents are not around

Ethics & Rules of Conduct of Interviews: How to approach & talk to respondents

- ✓ Field staff should always be courteous and tactful in dealings with households and CR.
- ✓ Field staff attitudes towards the respondents in the survey households must be one of respect.
- ✓ Field staff must always be patient towards survey household members. Be business - like in conduct – never bullying, demanding, or rude.
- ✓ Always act in a way that warrants respect and cooperation from the respondent.



Ethics & Rules of Conduct of Interviews: How to approach & talk to respondents

- ✓ During interviews, field staff should work efficiently and relatively quickly, but should not rush the respondents or make mistakes.
- ✓ After each interview field staff should thank each interviewee for their help and time
- ✓ Field staff should be willing to answer any questions the respondents ask field staff about the survey and its particular contents. If you don't know the answer, follow up with your supervisor.



Ethics & Rules of Conduct of Interviews: How to approach & talk to respondents

Field staff need to attempt a compromise between:

Maintaining a smooth-flowing, continuous dialogue

and

Allowing the respondents to ask any questions that they have about the survey so that they are convinced of its value and are cooperative.

Ethics & Rules of Conduct of Interviews: Children and Adolescents

The safety of the child / vulnerable adult is paramount when setting up interviews. The following general good practice should be adhered to by GAGE Team Members conducting interviews with children and / or vulnerable adults:

- The interview location should be safe for both the interviewer and the interviewee.
- If a child or vulnerable adult is required to travel, they must be accompanied by an adult chaperone (such as a parent, caregiver or trusted adult).



Ethics & Rules of Conduct of Interviews: Children and Adolescents



- Personal Boundaries
- Managing Behavior
- Photography



Ethics & Rules of Conduct of Interviews: Children and Adolescents



When interacting with children and vulnerable adults, GAGE Team Members ***must never***:

- Physically or verbally assault or abuse
- Develop emotionally exploitative relationships with children or vulnerable adults
- Develop physical or sexual relationships

Ethics & Rules of Conduct of Interviews: Children and Adolescents



When interacting with children and vulnerable adults, GAGE Team Members ***must never***:

- Act in ways that may place children or vulnerable adults at risk of abuse from others;
- Use language, make suggestions or offer advice which is inappropriate, or offensive to children or vulnerable adults;
- Do things for children or vulnerable adults of a personal nature that they can do for themselves;
- Condone or participate in behaviour of children or vulnerable adults which is illegal, unsafe or abusive;
- Discriminate against or show differential treatment or favour particular children or vulnerable adults to the exclusion of others.

Additional Tips for Working with Young Adolescents

- Be friendly!
- Have a good mood and nice facial expressions.
- Chat for a bit about the child's activities yesterday – it is not important to dive straight into the interview, but first develop a rapport with the child. Practice this during the training.
- Talk about the games we will play

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Ethics and Rules of Conduct of Interviews: Minimize Harm

- The research team, including the data collector, is responsible for the physical, mental and social well-being of the research participant.



Human Subjects

Ethics and Rules of Conduct of Interviews: Being Fair

- Fairness requires that the benefits and burdens of research are equally shared in the community.
- Researchers should also consider special care for vulnerable participants. Vulnerable participants could include people with disabilities or children.



Human Subjects

Privacy and Confidentiality

All study participants have a right to privacy and all members of the research team have a role to play in ensuring it.



Privacy and Confidentiality

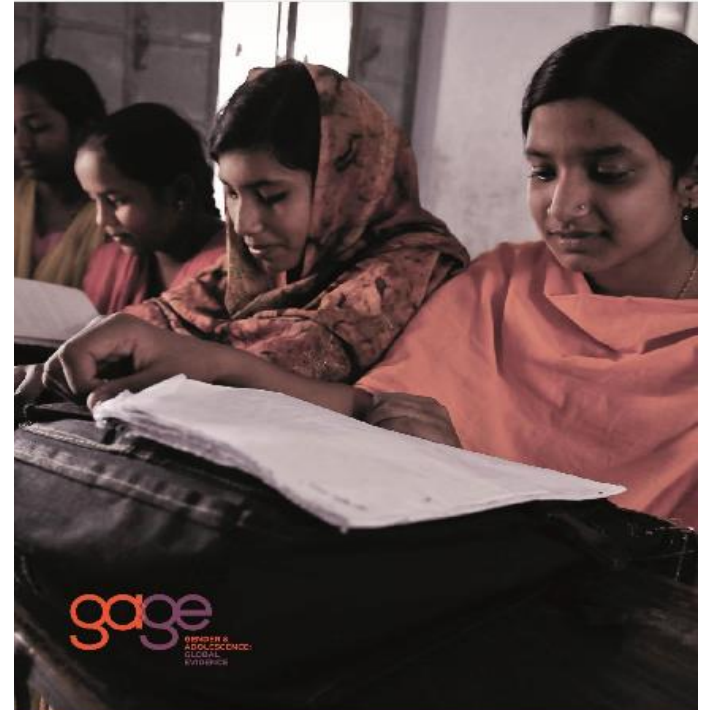
- One of the primary ways to cause harm to a study participant is intentionally or accidentally sharing any information (even if you don't think it is too private) that is learned by researchers.
- Confidentiality can be compromised through an unauthorized release of study information, which could have a negative impact on the subjects' psychological, social, or economic status.
- Researchers, especially data collectors, can also respect the personal privacy of study participants by not causing any unnecessary embarrassment or discomfort. It is important to note that cultural differences or customs that may infringe on privacy should be anticipated and minimized.

Child Protection



- Special protections in place for research that involves children.
- Since children, by definition, cannot give consent, the process of gaining consent from a child involves getting the child's *assent* and their guardian's *consent*.

GAGE Child Protection Policy



CHILD AND VULNERABLE ADULT PROTECTION POLICY

July 2016

Incident Reporting Form for Children



Scenario

1. Now that you have learned about the principles of respect, minimizing harm, and fairness, as well as issues around privacy and confidentiality and the child protection policy, lets brainstorm some scenarios that may come up during fieldwork.
2. Based on your teams experience collecting data in Jordan, take 10 minutes to come up with a scenario related to these issues that may arise during data collection.
3. You will be asked to report back: (1) describe the scenario, (2) what are the issues that it presents, (3) what methods would you use to mitigate the situation.

QUESTIONS?

